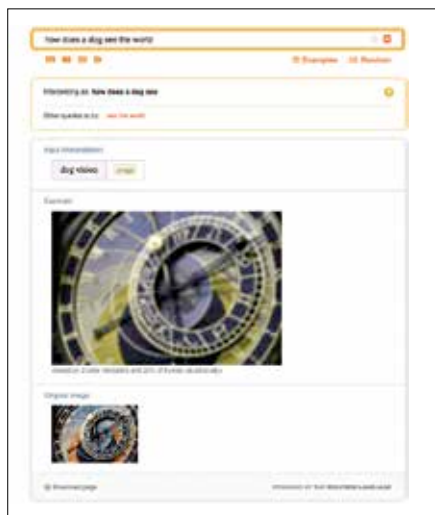


Academy, should you wish to explore the subject further. The premium version features a Teacher Dashboard – a place where teachers can create assignments for students and monitor their progress.

3 WOLFRAM ALPHA (<https://www.wolframalpha.com>)

You've probably heard of Wolfram Alpha and dismissed it as an imitation of Google, but it serves a very different, very awesome purpose. The 'Computational Knowledge Engine' is a service that takes in a natural language query and spits out



Wolfram Alpha can return some interesting results for your whimsical queries

a factual answer, crunching data from numerous sources along the way. The answers include graphical data, statistical information, mathematical computation and more. Want to find out how your dog sees the world? Just enter the query and you'll be presented with two images – a regular one as perceived by humans, and a slightly blurry one corresponding to canine vision. Other cool uses include finding the Scrabble score for a given word, interpreting the nutrition label on foods, analysing your social circle from your Facebook data, and even finding out if you're too drunk to drive. (Though if you have to ask, you're probably better off calling a cab)

4 OPENSTUDY (<http://openstudy.com>)

Study groups are a great idea, but only if you can manage to keep the

banter to a minimum and focus on getting work done. They can accelerate learning and foster creativity by means of discussions with your peers, which also makes it easy to get help on topics that might be difficult to grasp. However, the logistics of forming such a group may be complex unless you happen to live on campus. OpenStudy is a great option that lets you form online study groups with students all over the world for a variety of subjects. These groups also have Qualified Helpers – members who are certified to be experts in their domain and who'll be happy to lend you a hand. You can also sign up to become such a Helper if you're confident about your knowledge and like explaining intricate concepts to your fellow students.

5 PLAGIARISM CHECKER (<http://www.plagtracker.com/>)

As a student, one of the worst blunders you can make is to turn in an assignment or paper that contains plagiarised content. Most professors will employ sophisticated anti-plagiarism tools to scan your work, checking for any non-original content. It's usually a good idea to run your work through a tool such as PlagTracker, which lets you upload your document and sends you a plagiarism report. If you just want to scan a short piece of text instead of an entire document, <http://smallseotools.com/plagiarism-checker/> lets you paste some text into a text box and check it for originality. Of course, you might get a few false positives, but better be safe than sorry.

6 SHIKSHA (<http://www.shiksha.com>)

Choosing a college after graduating from high school can be a daunting task – there are several factors that go into the decision, not to mention the dozens of entrance exams and application deadlines one needs to be aware of. Finding this information isn't always easy, and college websites are often outdated or difficult to navigate. Shiksha is a one-stop shop for all your college and career related queries, with updated information on more than 14,000 colleges and 40,000 courses. You

can access college rankings and college reviews across streams like Engineering, Law, Management, Medicine, Hospitality, Retail, Media, Finance and more. Additionally, the site has details about application deadlines, fee structures, qualifying exams required and in the case of MBA programs, even lets you contact current students with your queries.

7 MATHWAY (<https://mathway.com>)

If you grew up fearing Math like the apocalypse and still wince at the thought of solving Math problems, fear not – the Internet's got your back. Mathway is a very powerful tool that takes the pain out of doing math by solving problems from fields like Calculus, Trigonometry, Statistics, Algebra, Geometry and even Chemistry. It also comes with an easy-to-use graphing calculator, letting you plot different types of curves to get a better understanding of the behaviour of different kinds of functions. If you upgrade to the pro account, you'll also get detailed, step-by-step solutions to your problem, doubling up as a study-aid. It's also a handy tool if you're majoring in Physics or Engineering and would rather outsource your computational heavy lifting so you can focus on the task at hand.

8 PIXLR PHOTO EDITOR (<https://pixlr.com/editor>)

While photo-editing is a category that probably warrants its own list of apps, it's quite unlikely that you need access to a full blown editor like Adobe Photoshop. It's expensive, it's resource-hungry, and chances are, your photo editing needs can be easily met by a free webapp like Pixlr Editor. You can easily use it to perform basic image editing –



Pixlr Editor is a powerful, browser-based photo editor